The caregiver tax credit checklist

For Canadian families helping an aging parent. For your 2026 return, due April 30, 2027.

The short version: most families caring for a parent leave money on the table because the receipts are scattered across three siblings' wallets and inboxes. Each credit below can usually be claimed by *whichever sibling actually paid* or provided the support, so decide who claims what *before* anyone files.

1. Canada caregiver credit (CCC)

- [ ] Your parent has an **impairment in physical or mental functions** and depends on you for support (you regularly help with basics like food, shelter or clothing).
- [ ] Claim on **line 30450** for a parent 18+ (they don't have to live with you). Up to **$8,773** for 2026, reduced if your parent's net income is over **$20,601**. Worth up to about $1,230 in federal tax, plus a provincial credit in most provinces.
- [ ] **Only one full claim per parent.** Siblings can split it, but the total can't go over the maximum. Agree the split in writing.
- [ ] No form to file, but CRA can ask for a **signed statement from a doctor or nurse practitioner** describing the impairment. Get one now and keep it.
- [ ] Single and living with your parent? Check the **eligible dependant amount (line 30400)** first; the caregiver amount then goes on line 30425.

2. Medical expenses you paid for your parent

- [ ] Claim on **line 33199** (medical expenses for other dependants). The sibling who **paid** claims it, with receipts in their name or showing their payment.
- [ ] Only the amount over a threshold counts: the lesser of **3% of your parent's net income** or a fixed amount ($2,834 for 2025, indexed each year).
- [ ] You can pick **any 12-month period ending in 2026**. Pick the one that captures the most expenses.
- [ ] Collect receipts for: prescriptions, dental, glasses and hearing aids, mobility aids, incontinence supplies, ambulance, private health premiums, and home care or nursing-home fees (see section 4).
- [ ] **Travel:** if treatment isn't available within 40 km, transport costs count; over 80 km, meals and lodging too. Log the dates and kilometres.

3. Disability tax credit (DTC) transfer

- [ ] If your parent qualifies for the DTC (**form T2201**, signed by a medical practitioner and approved by CRA) but doesn't have enough tax owing to use it all, the unused part can transfer to a supporting child on **line 31800**.
- [ ] The DTC amount was **$10,138** for 2025. Approval can be **backdated up to 10 years**, so ask CRA to reassess earlier years.

- [ ] DTC approval also unlocks more medical expense claims, such as **full-time attendant care** and some nursing-home fees.

4. Home care, attendant care and residence fees

- [ ] Get **itemized receipts** from agencies, PSWs and retirement homes that separate care costs from room and board. Only the care portion usually counts.
- [ ] Attendant care has detailed rules (amount caps, DTC, who the attendant can be). Have your accountant check before you claim it.

5. Home accessibility tax credit

- [ ] Renovations that make the home safer for a parent who is **65+ or DTC-eligible** (grab bars, walk-in tub, ramps, wider doors): up to **$20,000** of expenses a year on **line 31285**. A supporting relative can claim it.
- [ ] Some items can also be claimed as medical expenses. Ask which claim is better for your family.

6. Your province

- [ ] Most provinces have their own caregiver and medical expense credits on the provincial form (for example, **ON428** in Ontario). Quebec families file with Revenu Québec, which has separate caregiver credits.

7. Before anyone files: the sibling meeting

Decide	Why it matters
Who claims the caregiver credit, and how it's split	Double claims get reassessed. Splits must add up to no more than the maximum.
Who claims which medical receipts	The person who paid claims. Higher-income siblings may save more per dollar provincially.
Who handles the DTC application or transfer	One person should own the T2201 and talk to the doctor.
Where receipts live	One shared folder or app beats three shoeboxes.

This checklist is general information, not tax advice. Figures are federal amounts from CRA-indexed tables for the years shown and change every year. Confirm details at canada.ca/taxes or with a tax professional before filing.

SiblingTab keeps every receipt for Mom or Dad in one shared place, tagged by who paid and which line it goes on, so tax time takes minutes.

siblingtab.com